Incident Response Report – Mock Phishing Incident

1. Executive Summary

On August 18, 2025, a phishing email targeting employees was identified within the organization. The email impersonated an internal IT notification and attempted to harvest user credentials via a malicious link. One endpoint was compromised after a user clicked the link and entered credentials. The incident was quickly contained by isolating the affected system, preventing lateral movement. No sensitive data exfiltration was confirmed. Immediate remediation and awareness actions were initiated.

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2. Timeline

Timestamp	Action
2025-04-07 14:00:00	Isolated endpoint
2025-04-07 14:30:00	Collected memory dump
2025-04-07 15:00:00	Reset compromised credentials
2025-04-07 15:30:00	Blocked phishing domain
2025-04-07 16:00:00	Notified affected users

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3. Impact Analysis

- **Affected Systems:** 1 employee workstation
- **User Impact:** 1 compromised account
- **Data Exposure:** No confirmed data exfiltration
- **Business Impact:** Minimal; no service disruption
- **Risk Level:** Medium (credential compromise risk)

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4. Remediation Steps

- Isolated infected endpoint from network
- Reset user credentials and enforced MFA
- Blocked malicious domain and IP across firewall and email gateway
- Conducted full malware scan and system cleanup
- Reviewed logs for lateral movement (none detected)
- Initiated phishing awareness communication to employees

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5. Lessons Learned

- Improve email filtering rules for phishing detection
- Enforce Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) for all users
- Conduct regular phishing simulation training
- Enhance user awareness on suspicious links and emails
- Reduce response time through automated alerting

Investigation Steps Log

Timestamp	Action
2025-04-07 14:00:00	Isolated endpoint
2025-04-07 14:30:00	Collected memory dump

Phishing Investigation Checklist

- Confirm email headers
- Check sender authenticity
- Analyze email content for spoofing indicators
- Check link reputation (VirusTotal)
- Identify affected users
- Review endpoint activity logs
- Reset compromised credentials
- Block malicious domains/IPs

Post-Mortem

The incident highlighted gaps in user awareness and email filtering. Faster detection and automated containment reduced impact. Implementing stronger authentication, improving monitoring, and conducting regular phishing simulations will enhance resilience. Clear communication and structured response procedures ensured efficient handling, but proactive prevention measures must be prioritized to reduce future risk.